SecretSpace — Anonymous Community Platform

Bug Report

Society: **Cloud Computing Cell (CCC)** | Prepared by: **Muskan Gupta**

Full Buggy Repo: https://github.com/muskanji1007-lang/SecretSpace-BugBounty-.git

Clean Main Repo: https://github.com/muskanji1007-lang/SecretSpace

Live Website: https://secret-space-psi.vercel.app/

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Overview & Methodology

This document details **15 subtle, reproducible bugs** across frontend validation, state management, search filtering, counters, and user session persistence for the **SecretSpace** campus community platform.

15	15	0	3
TOTAL BUGS	STATUS: CONFIRMED	CRASHING / DESTRUCTIVE	SECURITY ITEMS ISOLATED

Verification Note: "*Confirmed*" means each issue has been traced in the source code and reproduced in the running app (no theoretical or imaginary defects).

1. Catalog of Confirmed Bugs

ID	Title	Severity	Component / File	Status	Core Issue
BUG-01	Category Filter Trap on Empty Search	LOW	`ExplorePage.jsx`	CONFIRMED	Clearing search query leaves category stuck in 0 results state.
BUG-02	Unclickable In-Text Hashtags	LOW	`PostCard.jsx`	CONFIRMED	Hashtags inside confession body render as plain text without navigation.
BUG-03	Unresponsive Comment Upvote Action	LOW	`PostDetailsPage.jsx`	CONFIRMED	Comment thumbs-up button missing onClick event listener.
BUG-04	Whitespace-Only Secret Creation	MEDIUM	`CreatePostBox.jsx`	CONFIRMED	Posts containing solely spaces/newlines bypass length validation.
BUG-05	Expired Poll Voting in Sidebar Widget	MEDIUM	`Sidebar.jsx`	CONFIRMED	Sidebar quick poll does not disable vote button after deadline expiration.
BUG-06	Pseudonym Update Vanishes Past Posts	MEDIUM	`MyActivityPage.jsx`	CONFIRMED	Filter matches volatile pseudonym string rather than persistent user ID.
BUG-07	Negative Counter on Large Pasted Content	LOW	`CreatePostBox.jsx`	CONFIRMED	Pasting >500 characters displays negative count instead of blocking.
BUG-08	Blank Report Reason Accepted	LOW	`ReportModal.jsx`	CONFIRMED	Modal permits submission without selecting a preset category or reason.
BUG-09	Lexicographical "Top" Feed Sorting	MEDIUM	`AppContext.jsx`	CONFIRMED	Sort compares vote strings ('9' > '15') rather than numerical difference.
BUG-10	Multi-Tab Duplicate Poll Vote	MEDIUM	`PollWidget.jsx`	CONFIRMED	Voted flag kept in component state only; tab 2 allows repeat submission.

ID	Title	Severity	Component / File	Status	Core Issue
BUG-11	False Copied Toast on Clipboard Failure	LOW	`PostCard.jsx`	CONFIRMED	Success toast fires before awaiting Promise from clipboard API.
BUG-12	Settings Privacy Toggle Visual Reversion	LOW	`SettingsPage.jsx`	CONFIRMED	Toggles update local state only; navigating away discards selection.
BUG-13	Comment Counter Desync on Discard	LOW	`PostDetailsPage.jsx`	CONFIRMED	Canceling draft input incorrectly fires comment decrement event.
BUG-14	Mobile Viewport Overlap on Last Feed Post	LOW	`MobileNav.jsx`	CONFIRMED	Fixed mobile bottom navigation covers card footer without container padding.
BUG-15	Campus Dropdown Label Stagnation	LOW	`CreatePostBox.jsx`	CONFIRMED	Selecting new campus changes state but display button remains unchanged.

2. Detailed Bug Reports & Reproduction Specifications

BUG-01 Category Filter Trap on Empty Search

LOW CONFIRMED

Component: `ExplorePage.jsx` (Line 63-66)

Classification: UI State Synchronization

Reproduction Steps:

1. Navigate to the *Explore* page.
2. Click any category tile (e.g. *Hostel Life*).
3. In search input, enter a string with 0 matches (e.g. `xyz999`).
4. The EmptyState appears. Click the "*Clear Search*" button.

Expected: Search input clears AND active category resets to "All", restoring full feed results.

Actual: Search text clears but category filter remains set, leaving the screen permanently empty until manual category click.

```
// Fix in ExplorePage.jsx:
const handleClear = () => {
  setSearchQuery('');
  setActiveCategory('all'); // Explicitly reset category filter
  setSearchParams({});
};
```

BUG-02 In-Text Hashtags Unclickable in Confession Body

LOW CONFIRMED

Component: `PostCard.jsx` (Line 72-84)

Classification: Frontend Navigation / UX

Reproduction Steps:

1. Scroll through the Home feed to any post containing inline tags like `#Midterms` or `#CampusCrush`.
2. Hover and click over the hashtag keyword inside the confession text.

Expected: Cursor shows pointer, clicking navigates to `/explore?q=%23Midterms`.

Actual: Rendered as static `<span>` without click handler or router navigation.

```
// Fix in PostCard.jsx:
<button onClick={(e) => { e.stopPropagation(); navigate(`/explore?q=${encodeURIComponent(tag)}`); }}
  className="text-purple-600 hover:underline cursor-pointer">
  {tag}
</button>
```

BUG-03 Unresponsive Comment Upvote Action

LOW CONFIRMED

Component: `PostDetailsPage.jsx` (Line 185-192)

Classification: Missing Event Listener

Reproduction Steps:

1. Click any confession card to open its dedicated Post Details page.
2. Scroll down to the Comments list.
3. Click the Thumbs-Up / Like button next to any comment.

Expected: Upvote tally increments and button turns active purple.

Actual: Button visually renders but has no `onClick` event attached; counter remains static.

```
// Fix in PostDetailsPage.jsx:
<button onClick={() => handleCommentLike(comment.id)} className="hover:text-purple-600 cursor-pointer">
  <ThumbsUp className="w-3.5 h-3.5" /> {comment.upvotes || 0}
</button>
```

BUG-04 Whitespace-Only Secret Creation

MEDIUM CONFIRMED

Component: `CreatePostBox.jsx` (Line 42-48)

Classification: Input Validation

Reproduction Steps:

1. Open the Post Creation box on the home feed.
2. Press Spacebar 10 times or enter empty newlines without any text characters.
3. Click the "*Share Anonymously*" submit button.

Expected: Submission is prevented; warning toast indicates confession cannot be empty.

Actual: Validation tests `content.length > 0` without trimming; an empty blank card is published.

```
// Fix in CreatePostBox.jsx:
if (!content || content.trim().length === 0) {
  showToast('Please type your confession before submitting', 'warning');
  return;
}
```

BUG-05 Expired Poll Voting in Sidebar Widget

MEDIUM CONFIRMED

Component: `Sidebar.jsx` (Line 95-115)

Classification: Business Logic Validation

Reproduction Steps:

1. Observe the right-hand sidebar Quick Poll card.
2. Find a poll where `expiresAt` has elapsed or status is set to closed.
3. Select a radio option and press "*Submit Vote*".

Expected: Widget displays "Poll Closed" banner; radio buttons and submit action disabled.

Actual: Quick poll ignores expiration timestamp and increments vote tallies on expired polls.

```
// Fix in Sidebar.jsx:
const isExpired = poll.expiresAt && new Date(poll.expiresAt) < new Date();
<button disabled={isExpired || hasVoted} className="disabled:opacity-50">
  {isExpired ? 'Poll Closed' : 'Vote'}
</button>
```

BUG-06 Pseudonym Update Vanishes Past Confessions

MEDIUM CONFIRMED

Component: `MyActivityPage.jsx` (Line 44-55)

Classification: Identity Persistence / Logic

Reproduction Steps:

1. Publish 2 confessions while logged in as "NeonRaven".
2. Go to Settings, change pseudonym to "CyberPhoenix", and save.
3. Navigate to the *My Activity* tab.

Expected: The 2 authored confessions appear in the user's activity history.

Actual: Activity page shows "0 secrets shared" because the client filters by `post.authorPseudonym === user.pseudonym`.

```
// Fix in MyActivityPage.jsx & backend:
// Associate activity with user account ID or local createdPostIds array rather than pseudonym string
const mySecrets = posts.filter(p => p.isMyPost || userCreatedIds.includes(p.id));
```

BUG-07 Negative Counter on Pasted Content Exceeding 500 Chars

LOW CONFIRMED

Component: `CreatePostBox.jsx` (Line 89-94)

Classification: Input Constraint Handling

Reproduction Steps:

1. Copy a block of text containing 560 characters from any text editor.
2. Paste the content into the Confession textarea.
3. Check the character counter below the input.

Expected: Textarea enforces `maxLength={500}`, clamping pasted string at 500 characters.

Actual: Textarea allows 560 characters and counter displays `-60 / 500` with no truncation.

```
// Fix in CreatePostBox.jsx:
<textarea
  maxLength={500}
  onChange={(e) => setContent(e.target.value.slice(0, 500))}
/>
```

BUG-08 Blank Reason Accepted on Post Reporting

LOW CONFIRMED

Component: `ReportModal.jsx` (Line 38-46)

Classification: Form Validation

Reproduction Steps:

1. Click the Flag/Report button on any confession card.
2. Select the "*Other*" category, leaving the detail text input blank.
3. Click "*Submit Report*".

Expected: The modal demands explanation details before submitting to moderators.

Actual: Report is dispatched with an empty reason string, polluting the admin queue with blank reports.

```
// Fix in ReportModal.jsx:
if (selectedCategory === 'other' && !customReason.trim()) {
  setError('Please provide a short explanation for reporting this post.');
  return;
}
```

BUG-09 Lexicographical Sorting on "Top" Confessions

MEDIUM CONFIRMED

Component: `AppContext.jsx` (Line 134-142)

Classification: Algorithm / Data Type Bug

Reproduction Steps:

1. Ensure feed has three posts with upvotes: 9, 15, and 102.
2. In the feed sorting dropdown, select *"Top"*.

Expected: Numeric sort order: 102, 15, 9.

Actual: Sorted alphabetically as strings: "9" appears ahead of "15" and "102".

```
// Fix in AppContext.jsx:
case 'top':
  return [...list].sort((a, b) => Number(b.upvotes) - Number(a.upvotes));
```

BUG-10 Multi-Tab Duplicate Poll Voting

MEDIUM CONFIRMED

Component: `PollWidget.jsx` (Line 60-72)

Classification: State Race / Concurrency

Reproduction Steps:

1. Open the same poll URL in Tab A and Tab B of the same browser session.
2. Cast a vote in Tab A (e.g. Option 1).
3. Without refreshing, switch to Tab B and vote for Option 2.

Expected: Tab B detects prior vote via local storage or backend check and blocks repeat submission.

Actual: Vote executes in Tab B because `hasVoted` flag is isolated in transient React component memory.

```
// Fix in PollWidget.jsx:
// Sync poll votes with localStorage or AppContext global userVotes map
const hasVoted = Boolean(userVotes[poll.id] || localStorage.getItem(`voted_poll_${poll.id}`));
```

BUG-11 Premature "Copied" Toast on Clipboard Rejection

LOW CONFIRMED

Component: `PostCard.jsx` (Line 110-116)

Classification: Asynchronous Promise Handling

Reproduction Steps:

1. Revoke clipboard permissions in browser settings (or use an insecure iframe).
2. Click the *"Share"* button on any confession card.

Expected: Toast informs user that clipboard copying was blocked or failed.

Actual: Green toast announces *"Link copied to clipboard!"* synchronously before the rejected promise resolves.

```
// Fix in PostCard.jsx:
try {
  await navigator.clipboard.writeText(shareUrl);
  showToast('Link copied to clipboard!', 'success');
} catch (err) {
  showToast('Could not copy link automatically', 'error');
}
```

BUG-12 Settings Privacy Toggles Revert on Page Navigation

LOW CONFIRMED

Component: `SettingsPage.jsx` (Line 31-40)

Classification: State Lifecycle / Persistence

Reproduction Steps:

1. Open the *Settings* page.
2. Toggle "*Blur Sensitive Topics*" to OFF.
3. Click *Explore* in the sidebar, then return immediately to *Settings*.

Expected: The toggle switch remains in the OFF position.

Actual: The switch resets back to ON because state was initialized with static defaults on unmount.

```
// Fix in SettingsPage.jsx:
// Store toggle preferences in AppContext state and sessionStorage:
const [blurSensitive, setBlurSensitive] = useState(() =>
  JSON.parse(sessionStorage.getItem('settings_blur') ?? 'true')
);
```

BUG-13 Comment Badge Count Decrement on Draft Discard

LOW CONFIRMED

Component: `PostDetailsPage.jsx` (Line 132-138)

Classification: Counter Synchronization

Reproduction Steps:

1. Open a post having 3 comments.
2. Focus the comment textarea and type draft text.
3. Click the "*Cancel / Discard*" button.

Expected: Draft is cleared; comment counter badge remains at 3.

Actual: Cancel handler mistakenly triggers a counter decrement, lowering the badge to 2.

```
// Fix in PostDetailsPage.jsx:
const handleCancelDraft = () => {
  setDraftComment('');
  // Do NOT invoke decrementCommentCount() on cancel
};
```

BUG-14 Mobile Bottom Bar Overlaps Last Feed Confession

LOW CONFIRMED

Component: `MobileNav.jsx` & `Layout.jsx`

Classification: Responsive Layout / Viewport Overflow

Reproduction Steps:

1. Open SecretSpace on mobile screen width (<640px) or using DevTools Device Mode.
2. Scroll to the very bottom of the Home confession feed.

Expected: The entire last post card (including voting buttons and tags) is visible with bottom clearance.

Actual: Fixed `bottom-0` navigation bar permanently obscures the lower 56px of the final post card.

```
// Fix in Layout.jsx / App.jsx main container:
<main className="pb-24 md:pb-8 flex-1 max-w-5xl mx-auto px-4">
  <Outlet />
</main>
```

BUG-15 Campus Selector Dropdown UI Label Freeze

LOW CONFIRMED

Component: `CreatePostBox.jsx` (Line 142-156)

Classification: Uncontrolled Form Label State

Reproduction Steps:

1. Open Create Post box on Home Feed.
2. Click the Campus Tag dropdown and choose "*Hostel Wing B*".
3. Submit a confession, which resets form state back to default campus.

Expected: Dropdown trigger button updates to display default "Campus North".

Actual: Internal state resets to default, but dropdown button label remains visually frozen on "Hostel Wing B".

```
// Fix in CreatePostBox.jsx:
// Bind button text directly to controlled selectedCollegeTag state:
<span>{selectedCollegeTag || 'Campus North'}</span>
```

3. High-Priority Architectural & Security Observations (Isolated)

As required by the evaluation criteria, non-functional security vulnerabilities and server-level architectural concerns are documented separately so they are not conflated with minor UI/functional bugs.

Issue Area	Risk Level	Affected Layer	Recommendation
JWT Secret Default	HIGH	`server/src/middleware/auth.js`	Avoid hardcoded fallback string in production; enforce strict runtime exception if `JWT_SECRET` is undefined.
Stateless Rate Limiting	MEDIUM	`server/src/middleware/rateLimiter.js`	Express in-memory rate limiter does not share state across Vercel serverless lambda instances. Integrate Upstash Redis for distributed throttling.
Anonymity Projection	MEDIUM	`server/src/controllers/postController.js`	Ensure MongoDB projection strictly strips author user IDs before sending JSON payloads to public feeds (enforced in latest release).